



and the smallest tank today is still as big as a cola can—and will provide only two minutes of breathing. Sorry Mr Bond—this doesn't gel with reality.

Having said that, we must give credit where it is due—hats off to the guys who thought this up. When Bond's engineers came up with this kind of portable design, portable air tanks had not yet been invented!

Coolness Quotient: 4

Plausibility: 2

Gadget: Omega Watch

Movies: *Golden Eye*, *The World Is Not Enough*

This beautiful Omega Seamaster is a collector's item in itself, but of course, for Q, and hence for Bond, beauty is not enough. By the time Q was done with it, this watch boasted of a high-power laser diode that could cut through two inches of steel! It also featured a button that could arm or disarm any deployed magnetic mines.

In *The World Is Not Enough*, the gadgetry is enhanced, and the watch incorporates a miniature grappling hook including a 50-foot high tensile micro filament, which could support a massive 800 pounds. Q also incorporates dual high-powered lasers into the design, and the casing is made of titanium.

Plausible?

Well, a lot of Omegas do come with a titanium body, but that's pretty much where the semblance to reality ends. Even if you could incorporate a high-powered diode into the watch, where would all the power come from? And let's believe that the wire filament can hold 800 pounds of weight, let's also suppose that the watch strap can withstand the same weight—we still fail to see how it's possible for a human wrist to take that much stress! Also, we think it's improbable that any 800-pound people would want to scale 50-foot walls!

Here, audience intelligence seems to have been ignored, and this watch, though absolutely cool, remains in the reel world.

Coolness Quotient: 3.5

Plausibility: 1

Gadget: Bell Textron Jet Pack

Movie: *Thunder Ball*

The pack strapped on to the user's back like a backpack, and was the size of about two scuba tanks, filled with propellants and a turbine thruster. With this



The Bell Textron Jet Pack Bond used in *Thunderball*

thing strapped on, the user could fly at extremely fast speeds to a height of 600 feet!

Plausible?

Oh yes! It sounds fantastic, but not only is it possible, it was, in fact, a working prototype on loan from the US Army. It can carry a person over nine metre-high (30 foot-high) obstacles at a speed of 11 to 16 kmph. Now that's what we call a flight of fancy!

Coolness Quotient: 4

Plausibility: 5

Gadget: Latex Fingerprints

Movie: *Diamonds Are Forever*

These false fingerprints were like latex stickers. Fingerprints were taken on hot latex, which was then allowed to cool and set in shape. You could stick it on to your fingers and assume a whole new identity!

Plausible?

Absolutely. Details of how to fake fingerprints are easily available on the Net, and all you need is things available in your own home. Of course, it's illegal to fake fingerprints!

Recently, a study from Yokohama National University in Japan showed that phoney fingers concocted from gelatine, called 'gummy dummies', were able to trick quite a few fingerprint systems.

Coolness Quotient: 3

Plausibility: 5

Gadget: Watch/Ticker Tape

Movie: *The Spy Who Loved Me*

The ultimate in faxing, this watch had an inbuilt satellite link. MI6 could send Bond short messages that would then be printed out on a spool of tape.

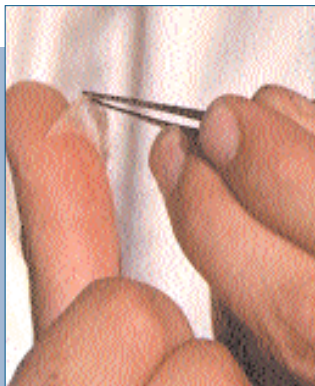
Plausible?

Not really. If you have ever seen a fax machine, you'll know that if it was possible to make the unsightly device any smaller, it would already be in mass production.

But the possibilities are interesting. Imagine a news report, or stock market updates, being spat out of your watch on ticker tape. You'd have to be careful to not trip on the tape though...

Coolness Quotient: 3.5

Plausibility: 1



Left: Fake latex fingerprints from *Diamonds Are Forever*; Right: The AR7 foldable sniper's rifle and the briefcase from *From Russia With Love*